2025

(NEP—2020)

(1st Semester)

HISTORY (MAJOR/MINOR)

(History of India up to Maurya Period)

Full Marks : 75

Time : 3 hours

The figures in the margin indicate full marks for the questions

(SECTION : A—OBJECTIVE)

(*Marks* : 10)

Tick (✓) the correct answer in the brackets provided : 1×10=10

1. Proto-history refers to people or civilization

(a) that were not familiar with the art of writing ( )

(b) whose script has remained undeciphered so far ( )

(c) who used sign language instead of script ( )

(d) with developed stone tools ( )

2. The earliest deciphered epigraphy in India is

(a) Brahmi script ( )

(b) Indus script ( )

(c) Kharosthi script ( )

(d) Tamil script ( )

3. The Harappans knew many industries, *except*

(a) dyeing ( ) (b) iron smelting ( )

(c) pottery ( ) (d) weaving ( )

4. Before coming to India, the Aryans had remained for some time in

(a) Asia Minor ( )

(b) Northern Iranian plateau ( )

(c) Afghanistan ( )

(d) They came straight to India ( )

5. The date of the Rig Vedic period is

(a) C. 1400–1200 BCE ( )

(b) C. 1000–500 BCE ( )

(c) C. 700–200 BCE ( )

(d) C. 1500–1000 BCE ( )

6. The idea of the soul or inner reality of an individual is called

(a) Karma ( ) (b) Samsara ( )

(c) Brahman ( ) (d) Atman ( )

7. The heterodox sects were known as

(a) Varna ( ) (b) Sapinda ( )

(c) Shramana ( ) (d) Pratiloma ( )

8. Alexander's movement beyond the Beas was prevented by

(a) Chandragupta Maurya ( )

(b) his soldiers ( )

(c) the joint force of Indian rulers ( )

(d) Porus ( )

9. Who was the author of *Indica*?

(a) Kautilya ( ) (b) Megasthenes ( )

(c) Vishakhadatta ( ) (d) Kalhana ( )

10. According to Romila Thapar, the Mauryan State was

(a) highly centralized ( ) *(b)* decentralized ( )

(c) loose confederation ( ) *(d)* segmentary ( )

(SECTION : B—SHORT ANSWERS)

(*Marks* : 15)

Answer *five* questions, taking at least *one* from each Unit : 3×5=15

UNIT—I

1. What is the Great Bath?

2. What are industry and assemblage?

UNIT—II

3. What is *Varna*?

4. What do you mean by the terms *gahapati* and *setthi*?

UNIT—III

5. What are the four *ashramas*?

6. What was the central belief among the *Ajivikas*?

UNIT—IV

7. What were the Greek-Roman texts used for reconstructing the Mauryan Empire?

8. Who was Kautilya?

(SECTION : C—DESCRIPTIVE)

(*Marks* : 50)

Answer *five* questions, taking at least *one* from each Unit : 10×5=50

UNIT—I

1. Discuss the literary sources for the reconstruction of early Indian history.

2. Discuss the decline and continuity of the Harappan Culture.

UNIT—II

3. Examine the archaeological and literary records of the material culture of Northern India during the 6th century BCE/post-Vedic period.

4. Discuss the debate on the origin of the Aryans.

UNIT—III

5. What factors underlay the emergence of the Mahajanapadas in the post-Vedic period?

6. Discuss the teachings and social relevance of Mahavira.

UNIT—IV

7. What factors underlay the emergence of the Mauryan Empire?

8. Discuss the Mauryan art and architecture.

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